

**ALIGN BY ABODE LTD**

# **Vendor Risk Management, Verification & Marketplace Trust Policy**

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**Document Owner:** Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC)

**Approved By:** Executive Management

**Review Cycle:** Annual

**Classification:** Internal and Vendor-Facing

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# Vendor Compliance and Acceptance/Onboarding

## 1. Document Control & Regulatory Mapping

### 1.1 Revision History

| Version | Date          | Author         | Description of Change                                                                                       |
|---------|---------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.0     | June 16, 2026 | GRC Specialist | Initial customized framework establishing formal processes for Vendor Compliance and Acceptance/Onboarding. |

### 1.2 Statutory & Regulatory Framework

To protect the platform's transactional ecosystem and ensure institutional grade compliance within the Nigerian Tech landscape, this policy explicitly enforces controls mapped to the following statutory instruments:

- **Companies and Allied Matters Act (CAMA) 2020:** Corporate entity verification and legal capacity validation via the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC).
- **Money Laundering (Prevention and Prohibition) Act, 2022:** Requirements for Customer Due Diligence (CDD) and tracking the source of funds to combat financial crime.

- **Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN) AML/CFT/CPF Regulations:** Systemic Know Your Customer (KYC) and Know Your Business (KYB) operational standards.
- **Nigeria Data Protection Act (NDPA) 2023:** Data privacy and security controls governing vendor-managed consumer data.

## 2. Policy Objective & Scope

### 2.1 Objective

The purpose of this document is to define the mandatory onboarding workflows, compliance checks, and risk acceptance thresholds required to verify third party vendors (such as property developers, corporate agencies, independent landlords, and brokers) before they are accepted onto the Align by Abode marketplace.

The policy serves a four-fold protection strategy:

1. **CAC Alignment:** Verifying that all corporate participants are legally registered, active businesses.
2. **AML/CFT Enforcement:** Guarding against money laundering, illicit cash flows, and platform financial fraud.
3. **Safety & Security:** Protecting prospective tenants and buyers from “BAD” listings, duplicate rentals, and unauthorized escrow collections.
4. **Standardized KYC:** Establishing reliable identity and operational baselines for every merchant.

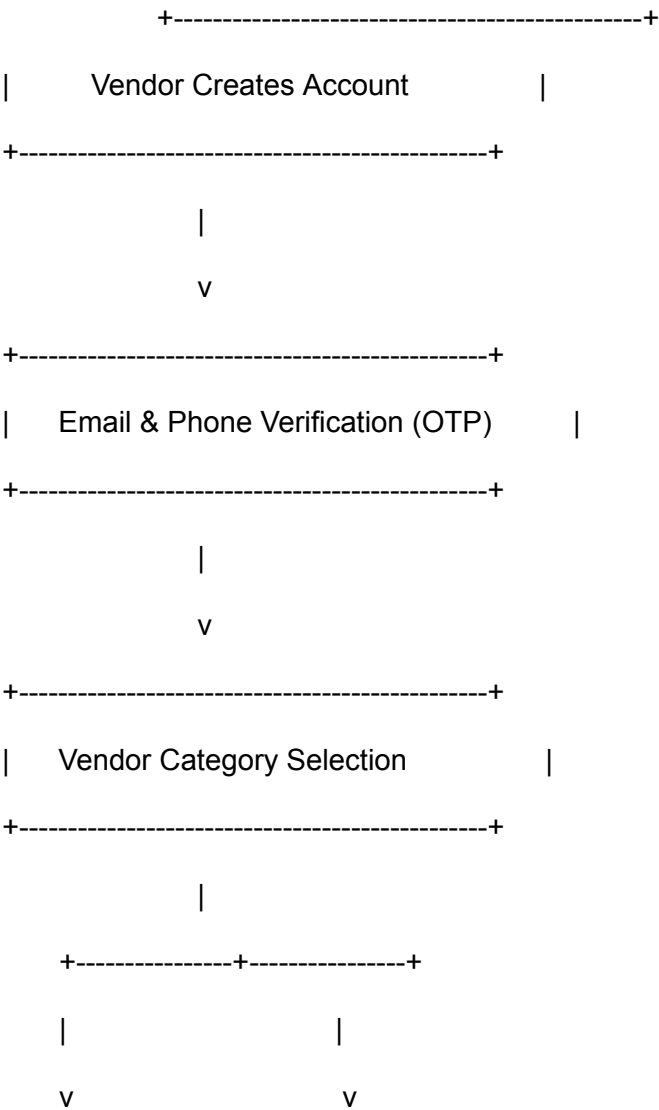
### 2.2 Scope

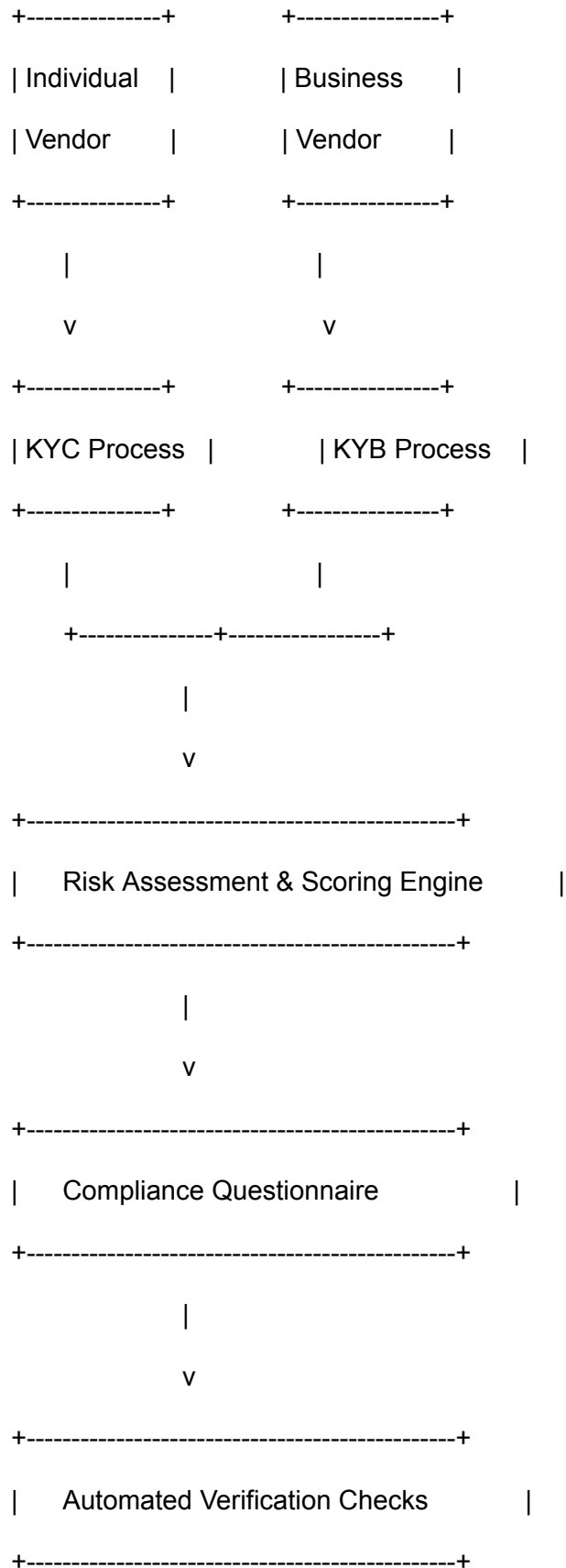
This policy governs the entire lifecycle of the Vendor Compliance and Acceptance/Onboarding process. No prospective vendor profile may bypass these gates, and no user account may be

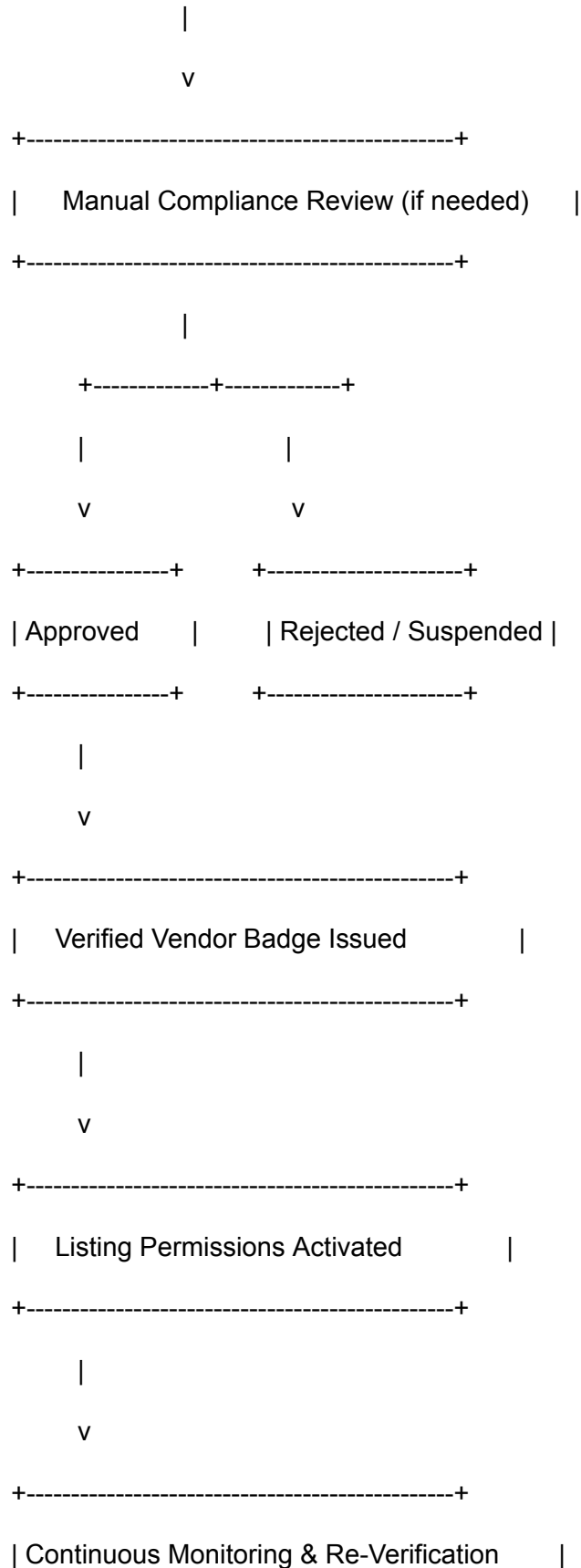
cleared to publish property listings or participate in the platform's escrow financial pipelines without achieving full compliance clearance.

### 3. The Onboarding & Verification Pipelines

Prospective vendors are sorted into two distinct verification streams at the point of digital registration.







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### 3.1 Stream A: Individual Vendor Pipeline (Standard KYC)

For solo property owners, landlords, or freelance agents, onboarding is built around robust consumer KYC to confirm real identities and physical origins.

1. **Government-Issued Identity Verification:** Submission of an active, unexpired government identification tool. System integration requires one of the following:
  - National Identification Number (NIN) via verifiable Slip or Digital Card.
  - Federal Republic of Nigeria International Passport.
  - Federal Road Safety Corps (FRSC) Driver's License.
  - Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC) Permanent Voter's Card (PVC).
2. **Biometric Safety (Liveness Validation):** To counter digital identity spoofing, vendors must complete a real-time facial liveness check. The platform's verification model cross-matches the real-time biometric portrait against the government registry database photograph.
3. **Proof of Physical Address:** Onboarding individuals must upload a utility bill (e.g., Ikeja Electric, Eko Electricity Distribution Company, or regional water board statements) or a formal bank statement dated within the last 90 days. This explicitly maps the operator to a verifiable physical location.

### 3.2 Stream B: Corporate Vendor Pipeline (Know Your Business - KYB)

For real estate investment companies, institutional property developers, and registered brokerages, onboarding relies heavily on corporate legitimacy metrics.

1. **Mandatory CAC Registration Verification:** The vendor must upload their formal **Certificate of Incorporation** or **Registration of Business Name** and input their Corporate Affairs Commission registration number (RC or BN Number).
2. **CAC Active Status Audit:** The onboarding software programmatically checks the entity's status via the CAC registry portal. If a company's status shows as "INACTIVE" due to unfiled corporate annual returns, the onboarding pipeline triggers an automatic hold.
3. **Taxation Legitimacy (TIN Checking):** Corporate vendors must submit their Tax Identification Number (TIN). The compliance team verifies this through the Joint Tax Board (JTB) or Federal Inland Revenue Service (FIRS) verification engines to ensure the company is operational.
4. **Ultimate Beneficial Owner (UBO) KYC:** Real estate is historically vulnerable to money laundering. Therefore, any director, shareholder, or partner holding 25% or more control or ownership in the corporation must provide standard Stream A individual KYC documents as outlined in Section 3.1.



## **4. Anti-Money Laundering (AML) & Platform Safety Checks**

Regardless of stream classification, all vendors must pass the baseline safety checks detailed below prior to system acceptance.

### **4.1 AML & Sanctions Screening**

Every individual vendor and corporate director is automatically screened against:

- Domestic and international financial sanctions watchlists.
- Politically Exposed Persons (PEPs) registries. If a vendor or director is identified as a PEP, onboarding is redirected to the compliance department for Enhanced Due Diligence (EDD) to trace the legitimate source of funds behind their real estate portfolio.

### **4.2 Property Inventory Safety Declarations**

To eliminate fraudulent listings, vendors must sign off on the platform Safety Clause during onboarding:

- **Proof of Legal Right to Sell/Lease:** The vendor must explicitly declare that they possess legitimate ownership, legal power of attorney, or formal agency rights for any property asset they list on Align.

- **Randomized Site Inspections:** The compliance policy reserves the right to freeze listings and request proof of ownership documents (such as a Certificate of Occupancy, Deed of Assignment, or Governor's Consent) if a listing triggers automated risk flags.

## 5. Vendor Compliance and Acceptance Questionnaire

The following digital questionnaire must be fully executed by the onboarding vendor before profile finalization.

| Regulatory Domain   | Onboarding Question Text                            | Accepted Inputs / Evidence Requirements                                 |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity Validation | What is your registered business structural layout? | Selection: Registered Corporation / Business Name / Individual Landlord |
| CAC Compliance      | Input your CAC Registration Number (RC / BN).       | Text string (System performs automated syntax and database validation)  |

|                                  |                                                                                                   |                                                                    |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>CAC Compliance</b>            | Upload your official CAC Incorporation Certificate.                                               | Digital Upload format: .pdf or clear image files                   |
| <b>Tax Compliance</b>            | Input your corporate Tax Identification Number (TIN).                                             | Numeric string (Cross-checked against the FIRS portal)             |
| <b>Safety &amp; Verification</b> | Do you own the legal listing rights for the properties you intend to advertise?                   | Selection choices: Yes / No (Selecting 'No' terminates onboarding) |
| <b>AML/CFT Screening</b>         | Do any beneficial owners or account managers hold a high-ranking public office or political post? | Selection choices: Yes / No (If Yes, routes to manual EDD)         |
| <b>Data Privacy (NDPA)</b>       | Do you formally accept data processor accountability under the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023?  | Checkbox Selection (Mandatory acknowledgement required)            |

## 6. The Acceptance, Hold, & Rejection Matrix

Following the evaluation of onboarding submissions, the GRC system routes accounts into one of three operational states:

- **1. ACCEPTED (Verified Status):** All identity parameters pass cleanly, the CAC registry verifies an "ACTIVE" business standing, tax status is validated, and AML check algorithms show clean results. The account is instantly authorized to list properties and displays a platform "Verified" badge.
- **2. CONDITIONAL HOLD (Pending Correction):** The compliance engine detects fixable, non-fraudulent anomalies (e.g., blurry document uploads, an expired utility statement, or an "INACTIVE" status flag on the CAC directory due to outstanding filing fees). The vendor is given precisely seven (7) business days to upload updated documentation before the application is canceled.
- **3. REJECTED (Permanent System Blacklist):** The verification review uncovers synthetic identities, altered/forged CAC registration documents, completely invalid registration numbers, or a match against active financial crime watchlists. The vendor profile is blocked, and associated communication channels (phone numbers, email domains) are restricted from creating future applications.